

TEACHING TIPS:

- Ask the children about the character of the song. What clues are in the music? It has a lively tempo and a cheerful tune. They might also mention the lyrics – words such as ‘perfect’, ‘beautiful’, ‘happy’, ‘haven’t got a care’.
- There is quite a lot of melodic repetition in this song which makes it easy to learn. The Words on Screen program is a brilliant aid to teaching the song line by line.
- The melody of this song contains some leaps. Practise the top B to low C in bar 5 ‘of year’ and bar 9 ‘be here’ to make sure this interval is clear and that there is no swooping down to the lower note.
- This is good song to use to try out part-singing for the first time, as the harmony part (the bridge) has already been introduced earlier in the song.

WHAT YOU NEED

Untuned percussion, sheets of paper and pens/paints

BRIGHT IDEA!

Throughout this song, the melody line of ‘Could there be a better time of year?’ is repeated ten times, with different words. Can the children **draw a rainbow in the air** with their arms every time this tune is heard?

STEP IT UP!

What other musical dimensions can you add to your graphic score? Perhaps use differently sized flowers to indicate **dynamics** – playing more quietly (*p*) or loudly (*f*).

DYNAMICS

Volume

Piano *p* – soft/quiet

Forte *f* – loud

TEXTURE

Layers of sound and rhythm

Notation

Improvise

Sing

Listen

Play

Compose

Genre/History/Musicians

ACTIVITY

AGES 4-7 

Make a graphic score!

Discuss the words of the song. What happens in spring?

Why does the song talk about ‘colours blooming everywhere’?

In groups of about three, use A3 sheets of paper and five coloured pens or paints to **create flower pictures** – have some pictures with just one flower and others with two or three, but make sure each individual flower is painted with only one colour.

With the children, choose an untuned percussion instrument to represent each colour, e.g. yellow/tambourine; orange/guero; purple/triangle etc. **Arrange the pictures** on a ‘washing line’ or wall/window to **make a score**. Follow the score using a pointer, either with the whole class or a group. The children should play their instruments (in any rhythm or style) as their coloured flower appears.

What happens when just one flower is shown? What happens when more than one flower appears on a picture?

(It will change the musical **texture**.)

WHAT'S ACHIEVABLE?

To play musical instruments while following a graphic score.

To explore dynamics.

To recognize repeated melodic patterns.